

Tests of Immune Function

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Do.
Make.
Heal.

Innovate.
Reinvent the Future.

Session Objectives

1. Be able to classify which immune function tests are appropriate for each relevant immune cell type
2. Be able to describe the mechanism of how each immune function test works
3. Be able to compare and contrast screening from confirmatory testing
4. Be able to interpret immune function laboratory data findings
5. Be able to differentiate which immune function tests are appropriate for specific disease pathologies



What to do first?

#1: **HISTORY AND PHYSICAL ARE INCREDIBLY IMPORTANT**

1. CBC W/ Differential
2. Chemistry Panel
3. UA
4. Chest Radiograph
5. Erythrocyte sedimentation rate
6. C-Reactive protein

When to be concerned?

History:

- Indicative of a familial origin
- Reason to believe in abnormal development
- Environmental changes
- Abnormal lab work in past: Anemias, Neutropenia
- Recurrent infections, Risk of HIV
- Patient's sex
- Failure to Thrive
- Fever of unknown origin

Physical Examination:

- Indicative of recurrent infections: *Candida albicans*
- Indicative of splenomegaly
- Multiple systemic features
- Check for lymph nodes

Prevalence of Immunodeficiencies

- Antibody Deficiencies: 55%
- Cellular/Humoral Deficiency: 15%
- Congenital defects: 10%
- Immune Dysregulation: 5%
- Autoinflammatory: 5%
- Complement: 4%
- Combined Immunodeficiencies: 3%
- Deficiency in innate immunity: 3%



Normal Lab Values

Erythrocyte count	4.6-5.9 million/ μ L
Hg	M: 12-16 g/dL F: 14-18 g/dL
Hct	M: 42-50% F: 37-47%
MCV	80-98 μ m ³
MCH	28-32 pg
MCHC	33-36 g/dL
RDW	$\leq$ 9-14.5%
Platelets	150,000-450,000/mm ³

Leukocyte count	4,000-11,000/ μ m ³
Segmented Neutrophils	50-70%
Bands	0-5%
Eosinophils	0-3%
Basophils	0-1%
Lymphocytes	30-45%
Monocytes	0-6%



Normal Lab Values

Red blood cell (RBC) count¹

Men:	4.5–5.5 million RBCs per microliter (mcL) or $4.5\text{--}5.5 \times 10^{12}/\text{liter (L)}$
Women:	4.0–5.0 million RBCs per mcL or $4.0\text{--}5.0 \times 10^{12}/\text{L}$
Children:	3.8–6.0 million RBCs per mcL or $3.8\text{--}6.0 \times 10^{12}/\text{L}$
Newborn:	4.1–6.1 million RBCs per mcL or $4.1\text{--}6.1 \times 10^{12}/\text{L}$

Hemoglobin (Hgb)¹

Men:	14–17.4 grams per deciliter (g/dL) or 140–174 grams per liter (g/L)
Women:	12–16 g/dL or 120–160 g/L
Children:	9.5–20.5 g/dL or 95–205 g/L
Newborn:	14.5–24.5 g/dL or 145–245 g/L

Platelet (thrombocyte) count¹

Adults:	140,000–400,000 platelets per mm^3 or $140\text{--}400 \times 10^9/\text{L}$
Children:	150,000–450,000 platelets per mm^3 or $150\text{--}450 \times 10^9/\text{L}$



Acute Phase Reactants

- Elevated in both acute & chronic inflammatory states
- Non-specific measure
- Indicative of general status of IS at the time
- Anything that increases by 25% during an inflammatory state
- **C-Reactive Protein (CRP):**
 - PRP
- **Erythrocyte Sedimentation Rate (ESR):**
 - Measures viscosity of blood
 - Increase in viscosity from fibrinogen break down

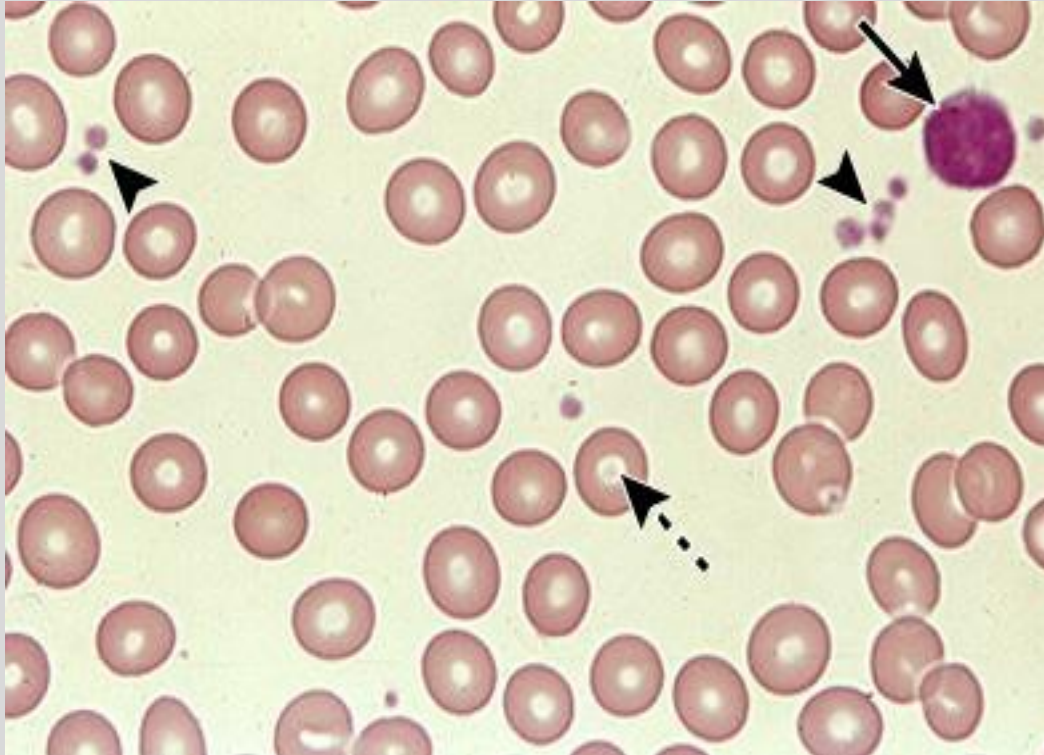


Acute Phase Reactants

- **C-Reactive Protein (CRP):**
 - PRP
- **Erythrocyte Sedimentation Rate (ESR):**
 - Measures viscosity of blood
 - Increase in viscosity from fibrinogen break down
- Named after reaction to 'C' arbohydrate proteins from 'C'apsule of streptococcus
- Elevations in inflammation, infection, injury, occasionally in chronic illness, age determinant



Blood Smear



Visualize:

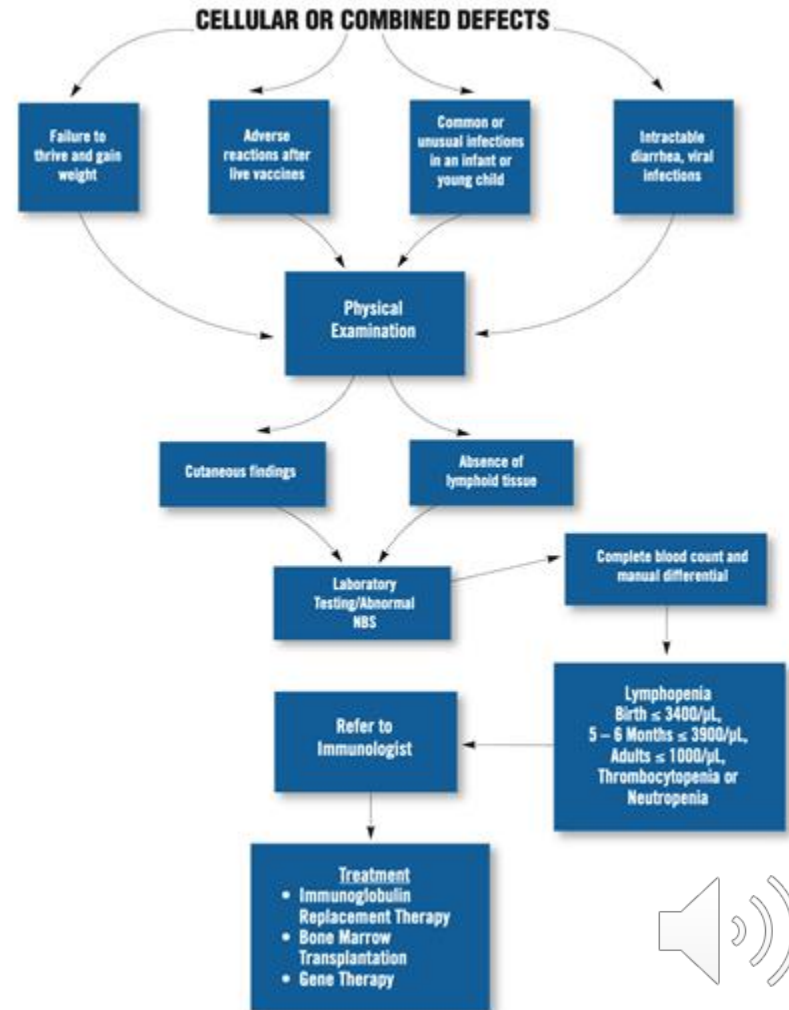
1. RBC
2. Platelets
3. WBC



Cellular Defects

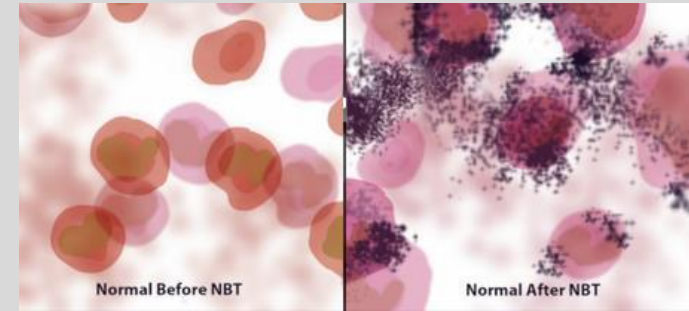
- Neutrophils: Innate
 - Phagocytosis with bactericidal enzymes
 - Provide extra support to macrophages
 - Derived from bone marrow
- NK cells: Innate
 - targets intracellular pathogens & tumors
 - IFN-Gamma to activate macrophages
- T-cells: Adaptive
 - CD4: regulator of adaptive IR
 - CD8: targets intracellular pathogens & tumors
- B-cells: Adaptive
 - Ab production

(Immune Deficiency Foundation, 2015)



Neutrophil Enumeration & Quality

- CBC w/diff & Absolute Neutrophil count:
Neutropenia:
 - Congenital: Severe congenital neutropenia
 - Iatrogenic: Cancer treatments
 - Infectious: Viral infections
- Dihydrorhodamine: DHR Flow Cytometry assay
 - Green fluorescence dye absorbed by cells
 - Chronic Granulomatous Disease
- Nitroblue Tetrazolium: NBT: NADPH Oxidase activity
 - Yellow to Blue by NADPH Oxidase
 - Chronic Granulomatous disease



(Liu, Lucy, 2021)



Neutropenia with Fever

- Calculate the Absolute Neutrophil Count
- Will be included on your CBC with differential
- $\text{WBC} \times \text{total neutrophils (bands and segs)} \times 10$
- Severe neutropenia is under 500.
- Concern for infection and possibility for growth stimulating factor initiation



Lymphocyte Enumeration

Markers commonly used for assessment of lymphocyte subsets by flow cytometry

Marker name	Cell type	Comment
CD3	T cells	Expressed on all T cells and no other cell type
CD4	T cell subset	Predominantly helper/inducer T cells
CD8	T cell subset	Predominantly cytotoxic T cells; expressed by up to one-third of NK cells
CD19 or CD20	B cells	
CD16	NK cells	Some NK cells may not express CD16
CD56	NK cells	Expressed on the majority of NK cells
CD57	NK cells	Expressed on the majority of NK cells; combinations of CD16, CD56, and CD57 will more reliably evaluate NK cell number than any marker alone
CD45RA	Naïve T cells	
CD45RO	Memory T cells	

CD: cluster of differentiation; NK: natural killer.

Graphic 78061 Version 5.0

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Causes of lymphocytopenia

Infection
Viral (eg. HIV, SARS, SARS-CoV-2, influenza, measles, hepatitis)
Bacterial (eg. tuberculosis, typhoid fever, brucellosis)
Fungal (eg. histoplasmosis)
Parasitic (eg. malaria)
Congenital immunodeficiency disorders
Iatrogenic
Immunosuppressive agents (eg. glucocorticoids, antilymphocyte globulin, alemtuzumab, rituximab)
Chemotherapy (eg. fludarabine, cladribine), hematopoietic cell transplantation
Radiation therapy (eg. total body irradiation, radiation injury)
Systemic disease
Autoimmune disorders (eg. systemic lupus erythematosus, rheumatoid arthritis, Sjögren syndrome)
Lymphoma
Other malignancies
Sarcoidosis
Renal failure
Aplastic anemia, pancytopenia
Cushing's syndrome
Other causes
Alcohol abuse
Zinc deficiency
Malnutrition, stress, exercise, trauma
Thoracic duct leak, rupture, diversion
Protein-losing enteropathy
Idiopathic CD4+ lymphocytopenia

HIV: Human immunodeficiency virus; SARS: Severe acute respiratory syndrome; SARS-CoV-2: SARS coronavirus 2.

Screening Tests:

- HIV: CD4+ ↓
- Thymic Aplasia: CD4+, CD8+ ↓
DiGeorge & Velocardiofacial syndrome
- Severe Combined Immunodeficiency: CD4+, CD8+ ↓
- Ataxia Telangiectasia: CD4+, CD8+ ↓

Lymphocyte Adhesion Defects (LAD)

- Integrin defects: Cells not able to migrate into the periphery tissue.
- 1st sign is **Lymphocytosis**: increased lymphocytes in CBC

1. LAD1: $\beta 2$ Integrin defect

- CD_{11a}CD₁₈ (LFA)
- CD_{11b}CD₁₈ (Mac-1)
- CD_{11c}CD₁₈ (p150,95)

- ## 2. LAD2: Fucosylated carbohydrate of **Selectin** is absent
- ## 3. LAD3: $\beta 1$, $\beta 2$, & $\beta 3$ integrins defective



Lymphocyte Enumeration: **NK cells**

- Check Levels for CD16+/CD56+:
 - NK deficiency syndrome: No NK cells
 - SCID: T, B, & NK cells
 - Paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria: Pancytopenia
 - Ataxia Telangiectasia: ↑
- Consider testing in severe, recurrent, atypical HSV infection
- Deficiency leads to susceptibility to: VZV, HSV, EBV, & CMV



Lymphocyte Enumeration: T-cells

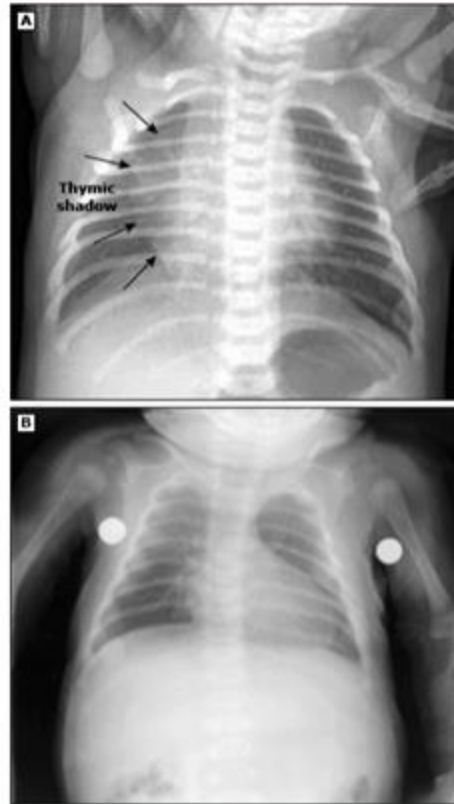
- Incredibly important for T-cell function & level to be intact
- Can lead to several combined pictures of immunodeficiency

Check Levels for:

- CD2+
- CD3+
- CD4+ & CD8+
 - Thymic Aplasia: secondary to DiGeorge's Syndrome
 - SCID: T, B, & NK cells
 - Ataxia-Telangiectasia: ATM gene



Chest radiographs with and without thymic shadows



The top chest radiograph (A) shows a normal thymic shadow. The bottom radiograph (B) shows absence of the thymic shadow in an infant with severe combined immunodeficiency (SCID).

Courtesy of J Pierre Sasson, MD.



HIV

- Screening:
 - ELISA: P24: Surface Antigen
 - IgM, IgG
- Confirmatory:
 - Nucleic acid amplification test
- PCR: qPCR of viral RNA
- Chronic HIV infection w/o treatment: Measure **CD4+ cells**



Lymphocyte Function: T-cells

- Stimulation of T-cells:
 - PHA: Phytohemagglutinin
 - Low stimulatory index, decreased T-cell function
 - Chronic mucocutaneous disease
 - Absent proliferation to candida antigen in vivo
- Cytokine production: IL-2, IFN-Gamma
 - IL-12R deficiency: decreased IFN-Gamma release
- TCR excision assay(TREC): circular DNA found in T-cells
 - SCID



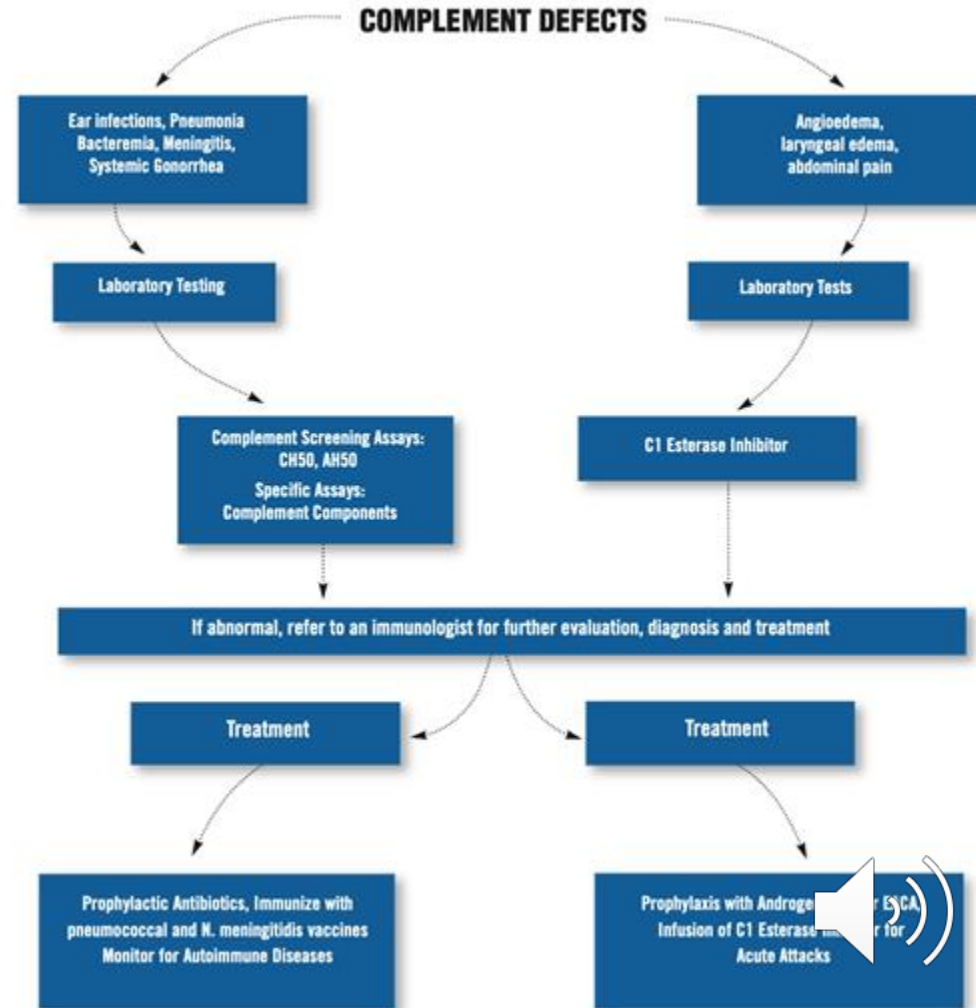
Lymphocyte Enumeration: **B-cells**

- Check Levels for CD19+, CD20+
- X-linked Brutons Agammaglobulinemia: Male predominant
 - No B-cell maturation: BTK gene
- SCID: T, B, & NK cells
- Ataxia Telangiectasia: ATM gene
- Pre-B Acute Lymphoblastic leukemia: Increased B-cells



Messenger Protein Abnormalities

1. Complement
2. Interleukins
3. Interferon



Complement Quantity defect

- **CH50:** Classical pathway, Hemolytic complement assay
 - non-specific, screening
- **AH50:** Alternative pathway: Hemolytic complement assay
 - Neisserial infection, most common indication
 - Determines deficiency in C3, C5-9
- **C1-C9 Enumeration**
 - SLE:** C1-C4 ↓
 - Neisseria* Bacteremia:** C5-C9 ↓



Complement Disorders

C1-Esterase inhibitor deficiency:

C4 ↓

-Hereditary angioedema

Further importance on history
taking and physical examination



Complement Disorders

- **Consumption:**
 - C3,C4
 - Lupus Nephritis
- **Deposition:** due to Ag/Ab complexes
 - C3, C4, & C1q
 - Post Streptococcal Glomerulonephritis: C3 ↓
 - MPGN: C3 ↓



Interleukins

- **IL-1a/1b**
 - IBD, RA, & Psoriasis
- **IL-4**
- **IL-5**
 - Allergic Asthma
- **IL-6/12**
 - IBD, RA, SLE, & Asthma
 - Castleman disease
- **IL-7/9**
 - Autoimmune diseases
- **IL10**



Actemra/Tocilizumab

- MAB, monoclonal antibody
- IL-6 receptor inhibitor
- Used in treatment of inflammatory and autoimmune conditions
- Different types of arthritis
- COVID-19 use
- Manifests in alteration of the cytokine release pathways



Interferon Gamma Release Assay

- **Used to determine TB infection**
- **IGRA/QuantiFERON:** WBC release IFN-Gamma
 - Antigen-WBC mix
 - Levels tested for amount of IFN-Gamma released
 - Response: Determinate of LTB infection
 - Lab should reveal both qualitative & quantitative response



Ab Defects

- **Deficiency:**

- Sinus and Pulmonary infections
- Give way to infection by:
 - Streptococcus Pneumoniae*
 - Haemophilus Influenzae*
 - Other viral agents

- **Overproduction:**

- Multiple myeloma
- MGUS
- Waldenstrom Macroglobulinemia



Quantitative Evaluation

- **IgG** in response to an Ag
 - IS detects Ag
 - B-cells function
 - Invalid if patient received Ig in past 6 months
- **IgA:** IgA deficiency an extremely common cause of immune deficiency.
 - Seen in recurrent mucosal infections, breakdown in initial barrier to infection (MALT)
- **IgM:** Brutons agammaglobunemia
- **IgE:** Hyper-IgE (Job) syndrome & Type I HSN



Quantitative Evaluation

- Wiskott-Aldrich syndrome: $\uparrow$ IgA, $\uparrow$ IgE; $\downarrow$ IgG, $\downarrow$ IgM
- AIDS: Increase in all Ig classes
- Ataxia-Telangiectasia: $\downarrow$ IgA, IgE, IgG
- SLE: Increase in all Ig classes
- RA: Increase in IgA or all
- Scleroderma: increase in all Ig
- Celiac Disease: Low IgA
- Primary biliary cholangitis: $\uparrow$ IgM



Levels of immunoglobulins in sera of normal subjects by age*

Age	IgG (mg/dL)	IgM (mg/dL)	IgA (mg/dL)	Total immunoglobulin (mg/dL)
Newborn	1031±200 ¶	11±5	2±3	1044±201
1 to 3 months	430±119	30±11	21±13	481±127
4 to 6 months	427±186	43±17	28±18	498±204
7 to 12 months	661±219	54±23	37±18	752±242
13 to 24 months	762±209	58±23	50±24	870±258
25 to 36 months	892±183	61±19	71±37	1024±205
3 to 5 years	929±228	56±18	93±27	1078±245
6 to 8 years	923±256	65±25	124±45	1112±293
9 to 11 years	1124±235	79±33	131±60	1334±254
12 to 16 years	946±124	59±20	148±63	1153±169
Adults	1158±305	99±27	200±61	1457±353

IgG: immunoglobulin G; IgM: immunoglobulin M; IgA: immunoglobulin.

* The values were divided from measurements made in 296 healthy children and adults. Levels were determined by the radial diffusion technique using specific rabbit antisera to human immunoglobulins.

¶ One standard deviation.

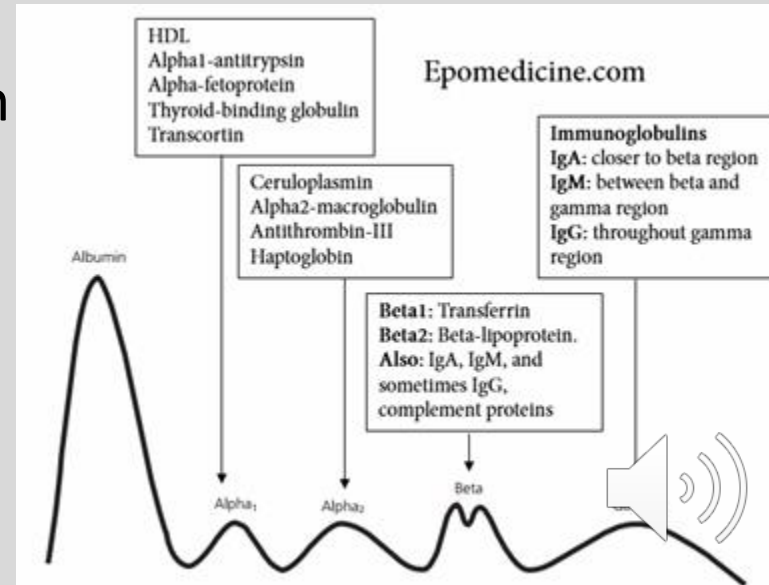
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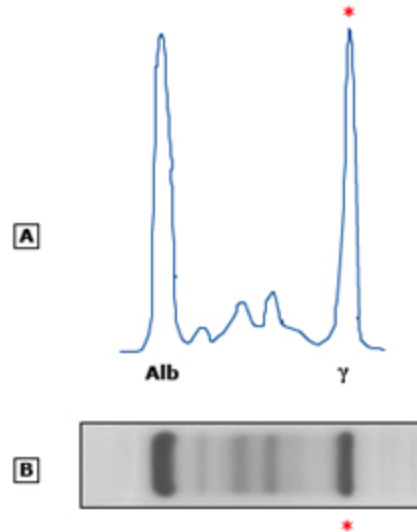


Quantitative Evaluation

- **Serum Protein Electrophoresis: SPEP**
 - M Protein of all Igs
 - Abnormal protein made that leads to pathology
- **Important in diagnosing:**
 - Multiple myeloma: IgG/IgA M-protein
 - MGUS:
 - <10% IgM M protein in Bone Marrow
 - Waldenstrom Macroglobulinemia:
 - >10% IgM M protein



Monoclonal pattern on serum protein electrophoresis (SPEP)



(A) Densitometer tracing of these findings reveals a tall, narrow-based peak (asterisk) of gamma mobility and has been likened to a church spire. The monoclonal band has a densitometric appearance similar to that of albumin (alb) and a reduction in the normal polyclonal gamma band.

(B) A dense, localized band (asterisk) representing a monoclonal protein of gamma mobility is seen on SPEP on agarose gel (anode on left).

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Type 1 Hypersensitivities

- **IgE** reaction to external Ag
 - Specific to Ag presented
 - Can lead to anaphylaxis
 - Increased level seen in Atopic patients
 - Involved in type I HSN
- **Skin Testing**
- **Exogenous/Environmental:** Food, pollen, molds, animal dander, & insects



Autoimmune

Anti-Nuclear Antibody: ANA

Anti-dsDNA/Anti-Sm: SLE

Anti-MPO/P-ANCA: UC

Anti-U1 RNP: MCTD

Anti-SSA/SSB: Sjögren

Anti-Scl70/Anti-DNA Topoisomerase: Scleroderma

Anti-Cardiolipin: SLE, Anti-phospholipid syndrome

Anti-CCP:RA

Anti-CD55/DAF: Paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria

Anti-Thyroid peroxidase: Hashimoto Thyroiditis

Anti-Parietal Cells: Pernicious anemia

Anti-Endomysial: Celiac disease

Anti-Smooth Muscle: Autoimmune hepatitis type 1

Anti-Mitochondrial: Primary Biliary cholangitis



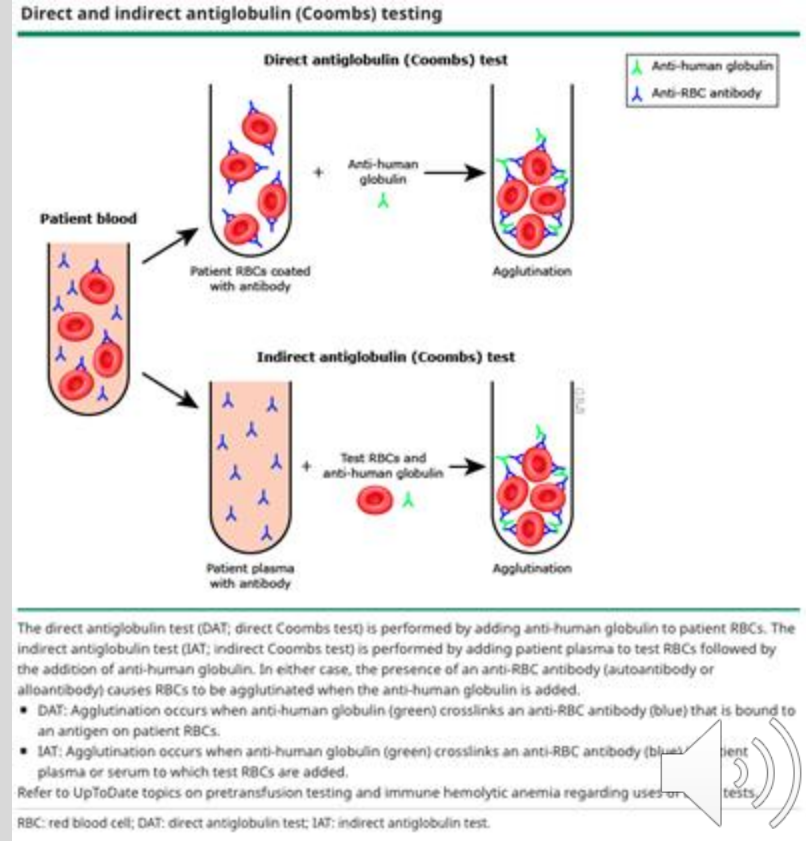
Vasculitis

- Cryoglobulins: Rheumatoid Factor
 - Rheumatoid Vasculitis
- ANCA mediated:
 - C-ANCA: Wegner's Granulomatosis
 - P-ANCA: Microscopic Polyangiitis
- Others:
 - a) **Rheumatoid vasculitis: RF**
 - b) **Cutaneous small vessel vasculitis**
 - c) **IgA Vasculitis**
 - d) **MPA and Churg Strauss**
 - e) **Wegner/GPA**

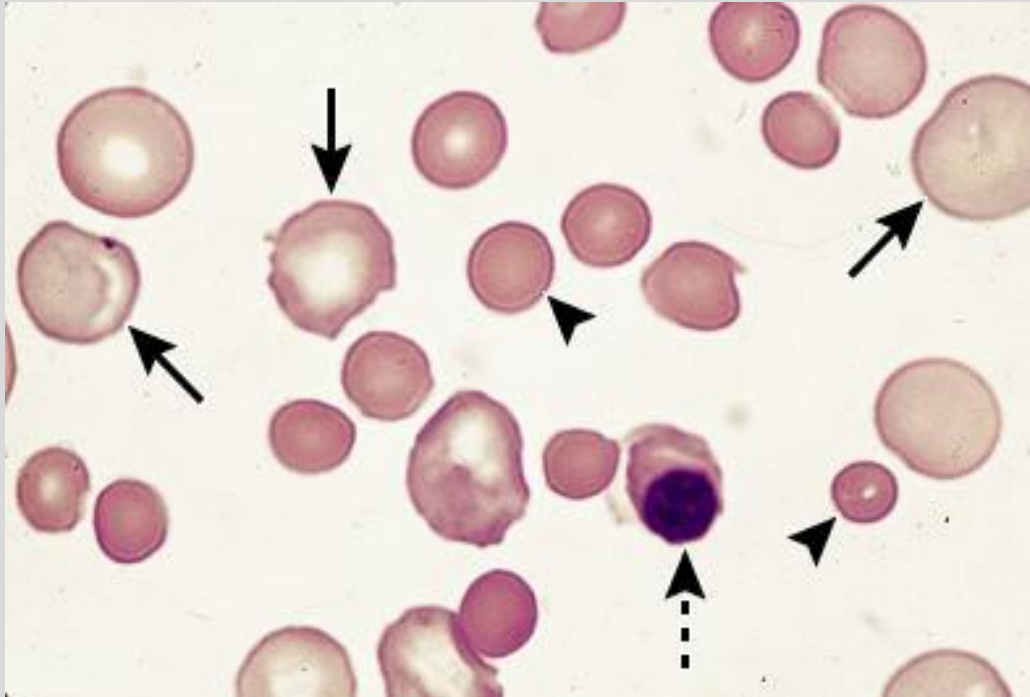


Direct/Indirect Coombs test

- Determine source of hemolysis due to autoimmune source
- Anemia, pretransfusion, suspected autoimmune hemolysis
- **Direct:** Check for Ab/RBC complex
- **Indirect:** Check for Abs for RBC in plasma



Blood Smear



Coombs-Positive

Autoimmune hemolytic anemia

1. Spherocytes
2. Nucleated RBC
3. Polychromatophilic Red Cells



Tuberculin Test

- Delayed/Type IV hypersensitivity
 - Intradermal injection with Ag: PPD
 - Requires **APC & CD4+ cells**
 - Not valid in those who have compromised cellular immunity
 - Wait **48-72 hours** after injections to evaluate response
 - Positive test - latent infection/Previous Vaccination



A comparison of tuberculin skin tests and interferon-gamma release assays

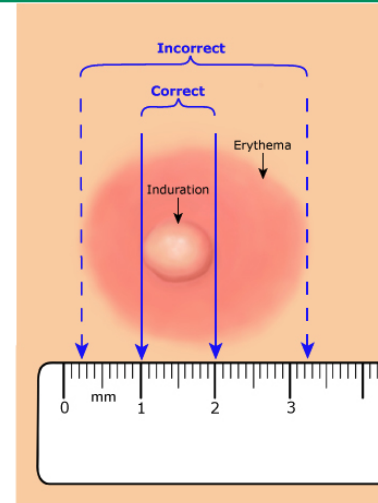
	TST	IGRAs
Advantages	TST does not require equipment and can be done without a laboratory. It is less expensive than for IGRAs (but greater personnel time is required). Longitudinal studies have demonstrated the predictive value of TST, and randomized trials show that LTBI therapy is much more effective in those who are TST positive than TST negative.	IGRA does not require follow-up visit to complete the testing process (but follow-up visits may be needed for LTBI therapy). IGRA does not give false-positive results because of prior BCG vaccination.
Disadvantages	TST requires an intra-dermal injection and a subsequent follow-up visit with trained staff to interpret results in 48 to 72 hours. TST may give false-positive results because of prior BCG vaccination or sensitization to nontuberculous mycobacteria. TST may give false-negative results because of immunosuppression (eg, HIV or active TB), natural waning of immunity, and technical limitations (including reader variability). Serial TST interpretation is complicated by potential boosting, although this can be minimized through initial two-step testing. TST can cause adverse reactions (skin blistering and ulceration); these are rare.	IGRA requires a blood draw, laboratory equipment, and technical expertise for specimen collection, processing, and assay. Reagent costs are substantially higher than costs of TST. IGRA test results are available within 24 hours at the earliest. IGRA may give false-negative results because of immunosuppression (eg, HIV or active TB) and technical variability. Interpretation of serial IGRA is complicated by frequent conversions and spontaneous reversions and by lack of consensus on optimum thresholds for conversions.

TST: tuberculin skin test; IGRA: interferon-gamma release assay; HIV: human immunodeficiency virus; LTBI: latent tuberculosis infection; BCG: Bacillus Calmette-Guerin.

Graphic 76107 Version 4.0

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Measuring a reaction to the tuberculin skin test



This figure shows the correct method for measuring a reaction to the tuberculin skin test. The size of the reaction is measured by the width of induration, not erythema. In the example shown, the reaction measures 10 mm.

Redrawn from: *Testing for Tuberculosis Infection and Disease*. In: *Core Curriculum on Tuberculosis: What the Clinician Should Know*, Sixth Edition, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, 2013. Available at: <https://www.cdc.gov/tb/education/corecurr/index.htm>.

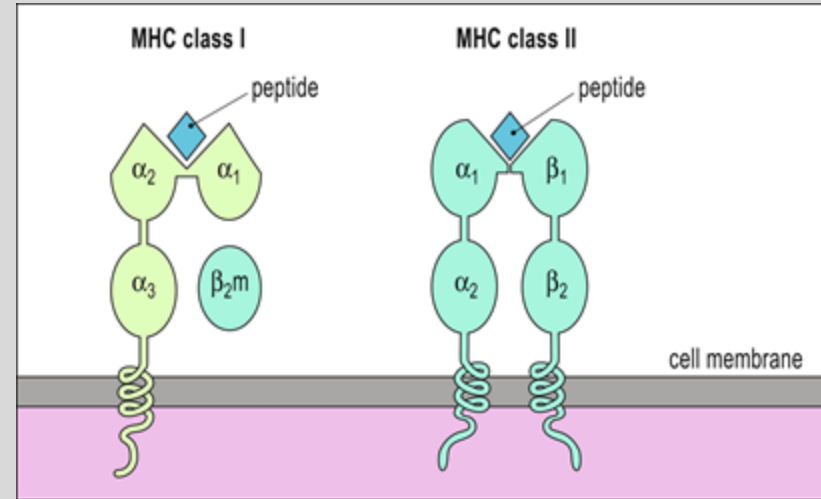
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Human Leukocyte Antigen

- **MHC-I HLA:** Self Ag
 - HLA-A, B, & C
 - Important in transplantation
 - HLA-DR2: MS, SLE, Goodpasture
 - HLA-DR3: DM-I, SLE, Graves
 - HLA-DR4: RA, DM-1, Addison's
- **MHC-II HLA:** Foreign Ag
 - HLA-DR, DQ, & DP
 - Associated with autoimmune:
 - HLA-B27: Psoriatic arthritis, Ankylosing Spondylitis, IBD-associated arthritis, reactive arthritis



(Male, et al., 2021)



Lecture Feedback Form:

<https://comresearchdata.nyit.edu/redcap/surveys/?s=HRCY448FWYXREL4R>

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